ADVERTISING UNPLUGGED

BRAND STRATEGY

Strategy Deck

A comprehensive brand strategy prepared exclusively for NovaBrew Coffee by Advertising Unplugged.

OVERVIEW

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CHAPTER

01

BRAND STORY & ORIGIN

BRAND STORY & ORIGIN

Founded in 2019 by former agency strategists, **NovaBrew Coffee** emerged from a simple insight: specialty coffee culture was booming, but the brands behind it were struggling to differentiate.

The Problem Worth Solving

The specialty coffee market grew 25% year-over-year, yet **78% of independent roasters** couldn't articulate their brand positioning beyond "we source quality beans." This created a sea of sameness.

The Founding Insight

Great coffee brands aren't built on bean quality alone — they're built on **story, purpose, and emotional connection**.

Core Values:

- Authenticity over perfection
- Community over competition
- Sustainability as a business model, not a marketing angle

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- NovaBrew addresses a €48B specialty coffee market with a strategy-first approach
- The brand's origin story connects founder motivation to customer pain
- Core values drive every business decision

CHAPTER

02

MARKET ANALYSIS

MARKET ANALYSIS

The European specialty coffee market is valued at **€12.3B in 2026**, growing at 8.2% CAGR.

Market Landscape

Market Size & Growth:

- Total addressable market: €12.3B (Europe)
- Serviceable market: €2.1B (Romania + CEE)
- Growth rate: 8.2% CAGR through 2030

Competitive Dynamics

1. **Mass-market chains** (Starbucks, Costa) — 45% share, declining loyalty
2. **Premium independents** (local roasters) — 30% share, fragmented
3. **DTC disruptors** (subscription brands) — 25% share, growing at 15% YoY

Trend Analysis

TREND	IMPACT	TIMELINE	OPPORTUNITY
Sustainability transparency	High	Now	Carbon-neutral packaging
Cold brew growth	Medium	2026-2028	RTD cold brew line
Subscription fatigue	High	Now	Community model
AI personalization	Medium	2027+	Taste profile matching

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The €2.1B CEE market is underserved by premium brands
- DTC disruptors grow 2x the market rate
- Sustainability and community are the strongest differentiation levers

CHAPTER

03

TARGET AUDIENCE PROFILE

TARGET AUDIENCE PROFILE

Persona 1: "Mindful Maria"

Demographics:

- Age: 28-35, Bucharest urban professional
- Income: €35K-55K, Master's degree
- Role: Marketing Manager at a tech startup

Psychographic Profile:

Maria values authenticity and sustainability. She researches brands before buying and pays 30-40% more for values-aligned products. Active on Instagram and LinkedIn.

Behavioral Patterns:

- Drinks 3-4 specialty coffees per day
- Subscribes to 2 food/drink newsletters
- Shares brand stories on social media
- Purchase decisions based on peer recommendations

Persona 2: "Curious Cristian"

Demographics:

- Age: 35-45, Cluj-Napoca
- Income: €45K-70K, IT Director

Psychographic Profile:

Hobby coffee enthusiast who upgraded from Nespresso to manual brewing. Watches YouTube reviews, participates in r/coffee.

Key Life Moments:

- Morning routine (daily ritual)
- Weekend hosting (impressing guests)
- Work-from-home transition
- Gift-giving seasons

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Two distinct personas with different entry points but shared values
- Both are digitally active and influenced by peer content
- Life moments create natural purchase triggers

CHAPTER

04

BRAND POSITIONING STATEMENT

BRAND POSITIONING STATEMENT

For mindful urban professionals who believe their daily coffee ritual should reflect their values, **NovaBrew** is the specialty coffee brand that delivers **transparently sourced, sustainability-first coffee** because great coffee should taste good AND do good.

Positioning Rationale

- **Mass-market chains** compete on convenience and price
- **Independent roasters** compete on bean quality and craft
- **DTC brands** compete on subscription convenience
- **NovaBrew** competes on **purpose + community + transparency**

Competitive White Space

No competitor owns the intersection of:

1. Full supply chain transparency (farm-to-cup)
2. Community-driven brand experience
3. Sustainability as measurable impact

Positioning Guard Rails

We always claim:

- Traceable sourcing with named farms
- Carbon-neutral operations with published metrics
- Community impact through profit-sharing

We never claim:

- "The best coffee" — subjective and generic
- "Artisanal" or "craft" — overused
- Premium for premium's sake

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Positioning occupies unique white space no competitor owns
- Guard rails prevent drift into generic messaging
- "Purpose + community + transparency" triad is defensible

CHAPTER

05

COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Comparison Matrix

DIMENSION	NOVABREW	ROASTER X	DTC BRAND Y	CHAIN Z
Price Point	€14-18/250g	€12-16/250g	€16-22/250g	€8-10/250g
Sourcing	Full traceability	Partial	Region only	None
Sustainability	Carbon-neutral	Organic cert	Claims only	Greenwashing
Community	Active	Local events	Online forum	None
Digital	Strong	Weak	Very strong	Corporate
Brand Story	Compelling	Generic	Good	None

Threat Assessment

Most Dangerous: DTC Brand Y

- Strong digital presence, well-funded (€12M Series B)
- Weakness: rigid subscription, no community focus

Most Vulnerable: Roaster X

- Quality product but weak digital presence
- Potential partnership target

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- NovaBrew's transparency + community + sustainability is unique
- DTC Brand Y is primary threat with structural weaknesses
- Digital investment is critical to compete

CHAPTER

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BRAND ARCHETYPE & PERSONALITY

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Primary Archetype: The Explorer

Driven by curiosity, authenticity, and meaningful discovery.

How it manifests:

- Product naming references origin stories
- Marketing focuses on discovery and education
- Community events framed as "expeditions"

Personality Traits

DIMENSION	SCORE	EXPRESSION
Formal ↔ Casual	7/10 casual	Warm, approachable
Serious ↔ Playful	6/10 playful	Knowledgeable, not pretentious
Traditional ↔ Modern	8/10 modern	Digital-first, progressive
Reserved ↔ Bold	7/10 bold	Confident, data-backed

Rejected Archetype: The Ruler

Rejected because it creates distance, implies hierarchy, attracts status-seekers over values-aligned customers.

Brand as a Person

A 32-year-old who's traveled extensively, runs a food blog, hosts dinner parties where conversation matters as much as food. The friend who knows the best local spots but never makes you feel uncultured.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Explorer archetype drives curiosity-based marketing
- Personality balances expertise with warmth
- Rejected Ruler clarifies what NovaBrew will never become

CHAPTER

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BRAND VALUES & MISSION

BRAND VALUES & MISSION

Mission Statement

To make transparently sourced, sustainability-first coffee accessible to mindful consumers.

Vision Statement

By 2030, NovaBrew will be the most trusted specialty coffee brand in CEE — measured by community impact, transparency, and advocacy.

Values Hierarchy

Primary Values:

1. **Transparency** — Every bean traceable, every impact measurable
2. **Community** — Growth through shared experiences
3. **Sustainability** — Environmental responsibility as business model

Supporting Values:

- Curiosity — Always learning, always improving
- Accessibility — Premium quality without premium pretension
- Integrity — Do what we say, measure what we claim

Values-to-Action Framework

VALUE	DAILY DECISION	EXAMPLE
Transparency	Publish sourcing data	QR code on every bag
Community	Prioritize engagement	Monthly virtual tastings
Sustainability	Choose impact over margin	Carbon-neutral shipping

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Mission and vision are measurable, not aspirational fluff
- Three primary values create a clear decision framework
- Every value translates to observable behaviors

CHAPTER

08

JOBS-TO-BE-DONE FRAMEWORK

JOBS-TO-BE-DONE FRAMEWORK

Functional Jobs

- "Help me start my morning with energy and focus"
- "Help me find coffee matching my taste preferences"
- "Help me serve impressive coffee when hosting"

Emotional Jobs

- "Make me feel good about my purchasing choices"
- "Make me feel part of a values-aligned community"
- "Make me feel like I'm discovering something special"

JTBD Analysis

JOB STATEMENT	TRIGGER	CURRENT SOLUTION	PAIN	OPPORTUNITY
Find ethically sourced coffee	Supply chain exposé	Random fair trade labels	8/10	Full traceability
Morning ritual that feels intentional	WFH routine	Generic subscription	6/10	Curated experience
Impress guests with unique coffee	Weekend hosting	Whatever looks premium	7/10	Story-rich packaging
Connect with coffee community	Isolation in hobby	Reddit, YouTube	7/10	Active community

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Emotional and social jobs are as important as functional ones
- "Ethical sourcing confidence" is the highest-pain opportunity
- Community connection is a structural advantage

CHAPTER

09

CUSTOMER JOURNEY MAP

CUSTOMER JOURNEY MAP

Stage 1: Trigger / Awareness

Actions: Reads article about supply chain issues, sees friend's Instagram post, encounters targeted ad

Emotions: Curiosity mixed with skepticism

Brand Opportunity: Lead with proof, not promises.

Stage 2: Research / Consideration

Actions: Visits website, reads farm profiles, checks reviews, follows on Instagram

Emotions: Growing trust, comparing 2-3 alternatives

Brand Opportunity: Educational content demonstrating expertise.

Stage 3: Evaluation

Actions: Compares pricing, reads subscription terms, looks for trial option

Emotions: Hesitation about price premium

Brand Opportunity: No-commitment tasting kit + social proof.

Stage 4: Purchase Decision

Actions: Selects tasting kit, chooses flavor profile, completes checkout

Emotions: Excitement mixed with hope

Brand Opportunity: Post-purchase transparency (sourcing details).

Stage 5: Post-Purchase

Actions: Tries coffee, scans QR code, shares on social, considers upgrade

Emotions: Satisfaction and belonging

Brand Opportunity: Community onboarding within 48 hours.

Critical Drop-Off Points

- **Stage 2→3:** 40% drop (price comparison)
- **Stage 3→4:** 25% drop (no trial option)
- **Stage 4→5:** 15% churn (first month)

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Two critical gaps: price perception and trial availability
- Post-purchase community onboarding reduces churn
- Every touchpoint should reinforce transparency

CHAPTER

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TONE OF VOICE GUIDELINES

TONE OF VOICE GUIDELINES

Voice Attributes

DIMENSION	POSITION	EXPRESSION
Formal ↔ Casual	7/10 casual	"Hey, let's talk about your coffee"
Expert ↔ Peer	6/10 peer	Knowledgeable but not condescending
Serious ↔ Playful	6/10 playful	Warm, sometimes witty, never silly
Cautious ↔ Bold	7/10 bold	Confident claims backed by evidence

Do's and Don'ts

DO	DON'T
"Sourced from Maria's farm in Huila, Colombia"	"Premium artisanal beans"
"Carbon-neutral since 2024 (here's the data)"	"We care about the planet"
"Join 2,400 coffee explorers"	"Buy now, limited time!"

Channel Variations

Social Media: Most casual. First-person plural, behind-the-scenes.

Website: Confident and informative. Lead with proof points.

Email: Personal and warm. First name basis. Value-first.

Advertising: Bold and visual. One strong claim per ad.

Before/After Rewrites

Generic: "Our premium coffee is sourced from the finest farms."

On-brand: "This week's roast comes from the Gutiérrez family farm in Huila — 1,650m altitude, washed process, dark chocolate and mandarin notes."

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Voice is warm, knowledgeable, proof-driven
- Specificity is the signature: names, numbers, origins
- Tone flexes by channel but voice never changes

CHAPTER

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VISUAL IDENTITY DIRECTION

VISUAL IDENTITY DIRECTION

Color Psychology

Primary: Deep Forest Green (#2D5016) — Growth, sustainability, nature

Secondary: Warm Cream (#F5E6D3) — Warmth, approachability

Accent: Burnt Copper (#B87333) — Craft, premium, earth tones

Typography Direction

Headings: Serif (DM Serif Display) — heritage and substance

Body: Sans-serif (Inter) — modern digital readability

Weight: Medium-bold headings, regular body. No ultra-thin.

Imagery Style

Photography:

- Natural lighting, warm tones
- Real people in real settings
- Close-ups of coffee process
- Farm photography with named individuals

Visual Principles

PRINCIPLE	APPLICATION
Transparency	Show process, not just product
Warmth	Natural lighting, earth tones
Authenticity	Real photos over stock
Simplicity	Clean layouts, generous white space
Story	Every visual supports a narrative

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Green + cream + copper bridges sustainability with warmth
- Photography must feature real people and places
- Visual identity: editorial and warm, not corporate

CHAPTER

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MOOD BOARD & VISUAL REFERENCES

MOOD BOARD DIRECTION

Overall Mood

Warm, earthy, authentic. Like a cozy morning in a well-lit coffee shop.

Image Descriptions

1. **Hands cupping a ceramic mug** — warm morning light, steam visible, rough texture
2. **Aerial view of coffee farm at sunrise** — lush green, mist, human scale
3. **Farmer sorting coffee cherries** — genuine smile, weathered hands
4. **Coffee beans on raw linen** — natural textures, earth tones
5. **Friends sharing coffee** — natural lighting, conversation visible
6. **Inside a modern roastery** — industrial, copper accents
7. **Hand-written tasting notes** — fountain pen, coffee ring stain
8. **Package being unwrapped** — kraft paper, QR code visible

Texture References

- Raw linen and natural cotton
- Kraft paper and recycled cardboard
- Copper and brushed metal accents
- Ceramic and stoneware
- Reclaimed wood grain

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Every mood board image features human presence
- Palette stays within earth tones
- Avoid clinical, corporate, or overly polished

CHAPTER

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COMMUNICATION STRATEGY

COMMUNICATION STRATEGY

Key Message Hierarchy

Primary: "Know exactly where your coffee comes from."

Secondary:

- "Join 2,400 coffee explorers"
- "Carbon-neutral operations, farmer profit-sharing"
- "From farm to cup — every step visible"

Channel Strategy Matrix

CHANNEL	SEGMENT	CONTENT TYPE	FREQUENCY	KPI
Instagram	Mindful Maria	Behind-the-scenes	5x/week	Engagement
LinkedIn	B2B	Thought leadership	2x/week	Connections
Email	All subs	Education + offers	Weekly	Open rate
Blog/SEO	Discovery	Long-form guides	2x/month	Traffic
YouTube	Curious Cristian	Tutorials, tours	1x/week	Watch time
Events	Community	Virtual tastings	Monthly	NPS

Content Pillars

1. **Origin Stories** — Farm profiles, farmer interviews
2. **Brewing Knowledge** — Techniques, recipes, equipment
3. **Impact Reports** — Sustainability data, metrics
4. **Community Spotlights** — Member stories, events
5. **Product Education** — Tasting notes, seasonal releases

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Five content pillars ensure variety with coherence
- Instagram and email are highest-priority channels
- Every piece traces back to a content pillar

CHAPTER

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GROWTH ROADMAP

GROWTH ROADMAP

Phase 1 — Foundation (Months 1-6)

Strategic Priorities:

- Launch DTC website with subscription
- Build initial community of 500 founders
- Establish 5 direct farm partnerships

Key Initiatives:

- Website development and launch
- Founding member campaign
- Content marketing: 20 origin stories, 10 guides
- Instagram + email infrastructure
- First virtual tasting event

Success Metrics:

- 500 subscribers by month 6
- 15% MoM growth
- 4.5+ average rating
- €50K monthly revenue

Phase 2 — Acceleration (Months 7-12)

Strategic Priorities:

- Scale to 2,000 subscribers
- Launch community platform
- Begin B2B channel

Key Initiatives:

- Community platform launch
- B2B pilot with 10 partner cafés
- 5 micro-influencer partnerships
- Cold brew line for summer
- First farm visit trip

Success Metrics:

- 2,000 active subscribers
- 35% retention at 6 months
- 500 monthly active community users
- €150K monthly revenue

Phase 3 — Scale (Year 2-3)

Strategic Priorities:

- Expand to 3 CEE markets
- Launch retail channel
- Build category leadership

Key Initiatives:

- Market entry: Poland, Czech Republic, Hungary
- Retail partnerships with premium grocers
- Annual impact report
- Brand ambassador program
- Limited-edition collaboration roasts

Success Metrics:

- 10,000 subscribers across 4 markets
- €1M+ annual revenue
- 25% aided awareness in target segment
- NPS: 70+

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Three phases with distinct priorities and measurable outcomes
- Community building connects all three phases
- Risk mitigation built into each phase

CHAPTER

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ACTION PLAN & IMPLEMENTATION

ACTION PLAN & IMPLEMENTATION

Top 10 Immediate Actions (Next 30 Days)

1. **Finalize brand identity package**
2. **Secure 3 farm partnerships** — Colombia, Ethiopia, Guatemala
3. **Build website MVP** — Shopify + subscription
4. **Create founding member landing page**
5. **Produce 5 origin story pieces**
6. **Set up email marketing** — Welcome sequence + newsletter
7. **Launch Instagram** — 30-day content calendar
8. **Order initial inventory** — 3 single-origin roasts
9. **Set up analytics** — GA4, social tracking
10. **Plan first virtual tasting**

Quick Wins (High Impact, Low Effort)

- Instagram Highlights with farm stories
- QR codes on packaging → farm profiles
- Referral program with founding incentive
- "Coffee Explorer's Guide" lead magnet

Prioritization Matrix

ACTION	IMPACT	EFFORT	PRIORITY	TIMELINE
Website MVP	High	High	P1	Month 1-2
Farm partnerships	High	Medium	P1	Month 1
Brand identity	High	Medium	P1	Week 1-2
Email marketing	High	Low	P1	Week 2-3
Instagram launch	Medium	Low	P2	Week 2
Community platform	High	High	P3	Month 3-6

Start / Stop / Continue

Start:

- Leading with transparency and proof points
- Building community before selling product
- Publishing impact data regularly

Stop:

- Using generic "premium" language
- Comparing to mass-market brands
- Delaying launch for perfection

Continue:

- Direct farmer relationships
- Values-driven decisions
- Customer feedback loops

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- 10 immediate actions provide a clear 30-day roadmap
- Quick wins generate momentum while strategic bets build moat
- Start/Stop/Continue makes daily decisions simple

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